Feedback Preparation Worksheet

Prepare feedback that is appreciative, objective and clear before you say a word.

How to use it. Fill this in before a feedback conversation. If you cannot complete the evidence and standard boxes in section 3, you are not ready to give the feedback.

1. The situation

Who, and when
The person, the date, the work or moment in question

What I want this conversation to achieve
One sentence

2. Acknowledge and appreciate

Always start here, whatever your relationship. Be specific about the effort, not only the result.

The effort I saw
What did they do, try or carry?

What I appreciate, and why it mattered
Name the effect on the team, the product or the user

3. The feedback, objectively

Replace “I think” and “I feel” with what you saw and what it is measured against. If you cannot name the standard, wait.

What I observed (evidence)
Facts: what was said, shown or shipped, with dates

The impact
On users, the work, the team or the goal

The standard or expectation
The level expectation, the goal, the agreed metric or a team tenet

What good looks like
The specific behaviour or output you would like to see next

4. Choose the method

- [ ] Sandwich: appreciate, the point, appreciate (a new relationship or a sensitive moment)
- [ ] SBI: situation, behaviour, impact
- [ ] Direct: acknowledge the effort, then say it plainly (trust is built)
- [ ] Feedforward: what to try next time, not what went wrong

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5. Support and follow-up

What I will do to help
Time, access, an example, a pairing

When we will look again
A date, and what we will look at

6. Before I go in

- [ ] I used evidence, not “I think” or “I feel”
- [ ] I named the standard it is measured against
- [ ] I acknowledged the effort and appreciated what worked
- [ ] I will ask for their view before I finish

> After the conversation, write down what was agreed and send it to the person within a day.

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